

King Sejong's Love for the People and the Story of Hangeul

drjay-ed · Hunminjeongeum daily lesson

Study Notes

1. Let's begin the story of how Hangeul was born!

Hello! Today I'll tell you the story of how Hangeul, the special writing Koreans use every day, was born.

2. King Sejong, who loved his people

Hangeul was created by King Sejong, the fourth king of Joseon. More than anyone, he had a warm heart that loved his people.

3. Chinese characters were too hard

Back then, people had to use difficult Chinese characters. They were so complex that most people could neither read nor write.

4. People struggled without writing

Unable to read, people suffered injustice in silence, and their lives were very hard. King Sejong's heart ached for them.

5. "We need our own letters!"

"We need our own letters that anyone can learn easily!" So King Sejong resolved to create them himself.

6. Research at the Hall of Worthies

With the young, brilliant scholars of the Hall of Worthies, he studied sounds and letters day and night.

7. He never gave up despite opposition

Many officials objected, "We must not abandon the old characters!" But for his people, King Sejong never gave up.

8. The secret of vowels: Heaven, Earth, Human!

The Hangeul they created is wonderfully scientific. Its vowels were modeled on heaven, earth, and human — "Cheon-Ji-In."

9. · sky — earth | person

'·' means sky, '—' means earth, ' | ' means person. Combine just these three and you get every vowel, like ㅣ, ㅑ, ㅓ, ㅕ, ㅗ.

10. Consonants = shape of speech organs!

The consonants are even more amazing — shaped after speech organs like the lips, tongue, and throat. 'ㄱ' came from the tongue blocking the throat.

11. Hunminjeongeum proclaimed, 1446!

In 1446, King Sejong shared these letters with all his people under the name "Hunminjeongeum" — "the correct sounds to teach the people."

12. Rain gauge, sundial, water clock — Sejong's works

King Sejong did more than create letters — he made science tools like the rain gauge, sundial, and water clock, and worked for music, farming, and defense, all for his people.

13. Thank you, King Sejong!

It's all thanks to King Sejong that we can learn Korean so easily today. May Hangeul be loved around the world — see you next time!

Key Words

천 · 지 · 인 · · · — · | · ㄱ · ㄴ · ㄷ · ㄹ · ㅁ · ㅂ · ㅅ · ㅇ · 훈민정음 · 한글